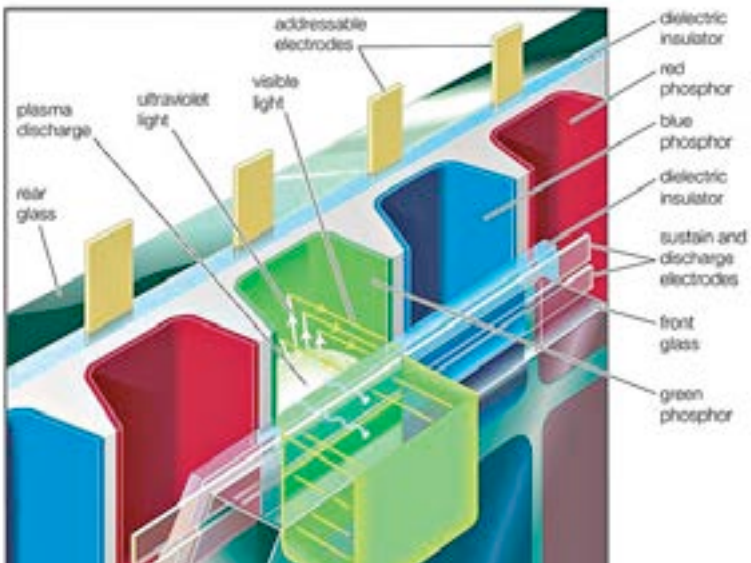


said this, each technology makes use of different materials for its pixels, with new and more energy efficient methods, hence requiring a slightly more in-depth understanding of individual tech. If you're still undaunted, go ahead. You should find all the information you need to help you out.

Plasma Screens

Let's start with plasma screen, which is probably the oldest of the lot we'll be discussing. The internal structure of the display screen involves gases like xenon or neon contained in thousands of cells in a grid like structure behind the screen, sandwiched between two glass plates. Each cell is a pixel, which has three subpixels. These subpixels are basically three different coloured phosphors, which blend together when excited to create the required colour. The plasma TV's computer collects the encoded information in the video signal to know which level to excite the gas to, which is passed on to a grid of electrodes that use the potential difference in them to create a current flow in each cell. The current creates a rapid flow of charged particles. The basic working principle involves exciting the molecules of the gas to a higher state using the generated current, turning it to plasma, one of the four fundamental states of matter. The pre-



Cross section of a typical plasma panel.